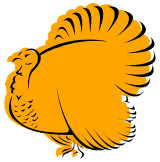
# N E W S L E T T E R

Congregation Tifereth Israel
Sephardic

**VOLUME 51 NO. 6** **NOVEMBER, 2021**





The Staff of the Newsletter wishes everyone a Happy Thanksgiving and a Joyous Hanukkah. This year Hanukkah begins on Sunday, November 28th, with the lighting of the first candle, and continues through the eighth day on Sunday, December 5th.

**ANNOUNCEMENTS:**

A business meeting of the Congregation will be held on **Sunday, November 7**, at 10:00 AM at the synagogue.

The Peabody Clergy and Ministerial Association will hold its Interfaith Community Service for Thanksgiving on **Tuesday, November 23,** at 7:00 PM at Temple Ner Tamid, Lowell Street, Peabody. Watch your email for details on joining the service virtually if you are unable to attend in person.

**CANDLE LIGHTING TIMES FOR SHABBAT:**

| | | | |
|---|---|---|---|
| November 5 | 5:14 | December 3 | 3:54 |
| November 12 | 4:07 | December 10 | 3:53 |
| November 19 | 4:01 | December 17 | 3:55 |
| November 26 | 3:56 | December 24 | 3:58 |

## *From the President...*

I would like to take this opportunity on behalf of Congregation Tifereth Israel to thank Elliot Hershoff for his 18 years of service as our president and spiritual leader. He always put CTI first and went above and beyond what was necessary. It will be hard to fill his shoes, but I will do my very best. I know he will be available for guidance when it is needed.

As we move forward, we find ourselves still dealing with Covid-19 while looking for what will be the "new normal". In that regard, all of our Shabbat services are now hybrid. Therefore as our Congregation ages and night driving becomes more difficult, you will be able to attend services from the comfort of your home while the rest of us gather in the sanctuary. With this capability, we will not have to cancel services in the winter and we look forward to greater participation from our membership.

Please try to attend our November 7 CTI business meeting at the synagogue. Although we are unable to provide breakfast due to Covid-19 restrictions, you are welcome to bring your own coffee and snacks.

Looking to the future, in February of 2022, CTI will reach its 100th Anniversary. We will be planning a celebration for this momentous occasion in the spring. At this event we will honor Doris and Elliot for their hard work and dedication to our Congregation. Watch for more information in future editions of the *Newsletter*. Anyone wishing to help plan and run the event please email me at jerry@jpcom.com.

*Jerry Pressman, President*

Thank you to the following members and friends who have made donations to CTI in memory of their loved ones whose Meldathos were observed during recent Shabbat services:

| Donated by | In Memory Of |
|---|---|
| Heidi August | Lloyd Nimaroff - Stepfather |
| Cynthia Garber | Aaron Garber - Husband |
| Arnold Gitter | Stella Gitter - Mother |
| Harvey Goldberg & Family | Lillian Goldberg - Mother |
| Lorna Goldberg & Family | Harold Linsky - Father |
| Lorna Goldberg & Family | Fannie Hasday - Grandmother |
| Doris Hershoff | Rachamim Yonis - Father |
| Doris Hershoff | Sophie Yonis - Mother |
| Doris Hershoff | Dora Pappos - Grandmother |
| Elliot Hershoff | Bessie Hershoff - Mother |
| Freda Kravetz | Ben Zion Pecker - Father |
| Freda Kravetz | Mendel Peck - Brother |
| Cynthia Linsky | Ruth Yonis - Mother |
| Phyllis Potash | Florence Levin - Mother |
| Phyllis Potash | David Levin - Brother |
| Joanne & Jerry Pressman | Simpson Barber - Grandfather |
| Joanne & Jerry Pressman | Sumner Pressman - Father |
| Jacob Romo | Sheila (Romo) Sprinsky - Sister |
| Adele Shackelford | Simpson Barber - Father |
| Adele Shackelford | Bessie Lanes - Grandmother |
| Adele Shackelford | Libby Gans - Sister |
| Adele Shackelford | Robert Pollock - Husband |
| Arlene & Joel Shenker | Marvin Melamed - Brother |
| Marcia Smokler | Robert Yudin - Brother |
| Wendy Tirck | Irving Parkin - Father |
| Wendy Tirck | David Tirck - Husband |
| Linda Weaver | Ruth Yonis - Mother |
| Joe Yonis | Rachamim Yonis - Father |
| Joe Yonis | Sophie Yonis - Mother |
| Joe Yonis | Dora Pappos - Grandmother |

Thank you to the following members and friends who have made donations to the **Happy Day Fund**:

| To - Occasion | Donated by |
|---|---|
| Paul & Phyllis Blyer - In Memory of their Daughter-in-law, Lisa Blyer | Patricia & Harry Stewart |
| Julie Cummings - In Memory of her Aunt, Lucille Sherman | Doris & Elliot Hershoff |
| | Phyllis Potash |
| | Jill & Steven Pressman |
| | Joanne & Jerry Pressman |
| Jacob Romo - In Memory of his Brother, Charles (Don) Romo | Doris & Elliot Hershoff |
| | Joanne & Jerry Pressman |
| Adele Shackelford - In Honor of a Special Birthday | Jan & Marvin Menovich |

**GET WELL WISHES**

To Jerry Becker, Dayle Chibnik, Samantha Cohen, Bob Duerr, Barbara Forbes, Elliot Hershoff, Paula Podradchik, Ryan Podradchik, Jack Romo, Sheila Romo, Charlotte Savage, Ann Marie Shaheen, Gloria Sontz, Harvey Tanzer, and Joey Thibault.

**FRIDAY EVENING SERVICE DATES**

| | |
|---|---|
| Kislev - November 5 | Tevet - December 10 |
| Shevat - January 7 | Adar I - February 4 |
| Adar II - March 4 | Nisan - April 8 |
| Iyar - May 6 | Sivan - June 3 |
| Tamuz - July 1 | Av - July 29 |
| Elul - September 2 | |

All services begin at 7:30 P. M. and include the reading of the Yahrzeit memorial names for that Hebrew month. Please make every effort to attend, in person or on Zoom.

## *Reflections on the High Holidays*

For those of us on the Bimah during the services on Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur, the perspective is quite different from someone sitting in the Congregation. As one of the religious leaders, I always experience a certain amount of concern and anxiety as the High Holidays approach. But this year, my worry skyrocketed as we were hit with obstacles totally outside our control.

In 2020, we experienced a new way of worship due to the arrival of a previously unknown pandemic, Covid 19. We began to meet on Zoom, and streamlined our High Holiday services to reduce the time we all spent at our computers, tablets, or other devices. Our Rosh Hashanah and Yom Kippur prayer books were downloaded and the appropriate pages turned into a Power Point presentation that could be displayed during the Zoom session to allow our members to view and read the prayers. We told ourselves that this was a "temporary fix" and certainly we would be back to holding our services in person at the synagogue the very next year.

By the close of 2020 and the start of 2021, major renovations and safety measures were completed in our building while it was closed. We added a permanent camera mount and prepared for another innovation: A "hybrid service" where congregants had the choice of coming to the synagogue or viewing from home. We planned for the High Holidays with every confidence that we could keep our members safe from the spread of Covid 19, with most people vaccinated, and social distancing and masks no longer required. By early August, however, reports of increased infections from the disease began to surface. Masks began to re-appear in supermarkets and other retail establishments. We again had to worry about protecting everyone who would be present during the holidays.

We persevered through this with the help of members, Bob Duerr, Marvin Menovich, and Jerry Pressman. We purchased an air purifier with a HEPA filter and ultra-violet light. Bob used an aerosolized spray to sanitize all surfaces. Masks were made available. The air conditioners in the sanctuary were serviced and back in working order. We were ready to go!

Then the ultimate blow to all our careful planning happened. On the long Labor Day holiday weekend, we discovered that there were bees entering the sanctuary through the air conditioner. All our hard work was no match for Mother Nature. Although we finally found an exterminator to eliminate the bees (at considerable expense), we absolutely could not take the chance that the sanctuary would be safe in time for Rosh Hashanah. So again we were required to step up and make changes.

Thank you to everyone who worked so hard to pivot our Rosh Hashanah services to revert to virtual only. First we held an emergency board meeting to vote on this change and all the steps required to make it happen in less than 48 hours. Every member of the board helped to make phone calls to the members, and an email was sent informing people of the change. David Podradchik agreed to use his personal Torah for Rosh Hashanah. Aliyahs were rescheduled and confirmed for Zoom. The police detail reserved for security and the flowers ordered for the Bimah both had to be cancelled. To say this was a major disappointment would be a complete understatement. Amazingly the Rosh Hashanah service was held virtually without any other glitches.

The next week, we finally utilized all our planning and hard work. We held Kol Nidre and Yom Kippur services in the sanctuary. Our High Holiday services this year (both virtual and in-person) all turned out to be beautiful, meaningful, and well attended. Thank you to all the volunteers, workers, and members who made it so: to Jerry Pressman and Steven Pressman for handling the technology to display our prayer books on Zoom during the High Holiday services; to our High Holiday volunteer readers, Millie Becker, Betty Polonsky, and Wendy Tirck; to Bob Duerr for providing us with masks and coming in to sanitize the synagogue during the High Holidays.

We should all be proud of the heritage and traditions of our small Sephardic congregation as it approaches its 100th year. Yasher Koach! May you go from strength to strength!

*Joanne Pressman*

## YAHRZEIT - MELDATHOS

| NOVEMBER | | KISLEV |
|---|---|---|
| **Service Friday, Nov. 5, 7:30 PM** | | |
| 5 | William Barber | 1 |
| 6 | Sidney Sands | 2 |
| 7 | Mark Kasarjian | 3 |
| 7 | Esther Savy | 3 |
| 8 | Charles (Don) Romo | 4 |
| 9 | Judith Epstein | 5 |
| 10 | Richard Yonis | 6 |
| 10 | Bernice Edelstein | 6 |
| 11 | Michael Lanes | 7 |
| 13 | Morris Becker | 9 |
| 15 | John (Jack) Yonis | 11 |
| 15 | Marshall Yudin | 11 |
| 15 | Barbara Adams | 11 |
| 19 | Max Blair | 15 |
| 20 | Amy Macomber | 16 |
| 22 | May August Nimaroff | 18 |
| 23 | Lucille Sherman | 19 |
| 26 | Emili Pernitchi | 22 |
| 26 | Victor Savy | 22 |
| 27 | Sarah Bengar | 23 |
| 27 | Joseph Romo | 23 |
| 28 | Leo Gibely | 24 |
| 28 | Robert Hasday | 24 |
| 29 | Philomena Duerr | 25 |
| 30 | Daniel Leavitt | 26 |
| **DECEMBER** | | |
| 1 | Sara Savy | 27 |
| 3 | Harry Savage | 29 |
| 3 | David Sherman | 29 |
| 4 | Norma Alpert | 30 |

| DECEMBER | | TEVET |
|---|---|---|
| **Service Friday, Dec. 10, 7:30 PM** | | |
| 5 | Joseph Polonsky | 1 |
| 5 | Ronald Tanzer | 1 |
| 6 | Sidney Sands | 2 |
| 6 | Kenneth Furtado | 2 |
| 8 | Charles (Don) Romo | 4 |
| 9 | Rose Harsfield | 5 |
| 10 | Bernice Edelstein | 6 |
| 11 | Lynn Shackelford | 7 |
| 11 | Harold Sumberg | 7 |
| 12 | Rebecca Sholomith | 8 |
| 14 | Ada Millstein | 10 |
| 15 | Edward Baum | 11 |
| 15 | Robert M. Hasday | 11 |
| 16 | Joseph Gibely | 12 |
| 17 | Esther Eskenazi | 13 |
| 17 | Morris Fins | 13 |
| 20 | Amy Macomber | 16 |
| 21 | Ralph Polonsky | 17 |
| 22 | Esther Gibely | 18 |
| 22 | May August Nimaroff | 18 |
| 23 | Lucille Sherman | 19 |
| 25 | Cindy Gibeley | 21 |
| 26 | Sarah Whitcomb | 22 |
| 26 | Mathew Smokler | 22 |
| 27 | Esther Gibeley I | 23 |
| 27 | Esther Miller | 23 |
| 27 | Irving Sacks | 23 |
| **JANUARY** | | |
| 1 | Calef Havio | 28 |
| 2 | Lionel Harsfield | 29 |

## BIRTHDAYS

| NOVEMBER | | DECEMBER | |
|---|---|---|---|
| 3 | Adam Podradchik | 3 | Betty Polonsky |
| 5 | Terry Simon | 4 | Michelle Fain |
| 7 | Joshua Arsenault | 4 | Steven Pressman |
| 7 | Ryan Podradchik | 7 | Bradley Thompson |
| 10 | Julia Podradchik | 8 | Jacob Arsenault |
| 13 | Andrea Cohen | 9 | Anita Horowitz |
| 17 | David Frasch | 11 | John Shaheen |
| 19 | Patricia Stewart | 16 | Michelle Becker |
| 21 | Kathy Blair | 16 | Robin Murby |
| 22 | Aimee Arsenault | 20 | Steven Polonsky |
| 22 | Heather Rowen | 20 | Lisa Gayle Rizzo |
| 23 | Linda Weaver | 21 | Sarah Kraus |
| 24 | Benjamin Savage | 23 | Scott Goldberg |
| 25 | Erika Romo | 23 | Scott Simon |
| 28 | Brooke Arsenault | 24 | Paula Cohen |
| 29 | Samantha Kraus | 24 | Mark Fain |
| 30 | Eric Jagher | 25 | Diane Elefson |
| | | 30 | Kimberley Civitarese |

## ANNIVERSARIES

**NOVEMBER**

22 Mr. & Mrs. Morris D. Gibely

**DECEMBER**

1 Mr. & Mrs. Lewis Freedman
6 Mr. & Mrs. Robert Duerr
22 Mr. & Mrs. Randy Hershoff
24 Mr. & Mrs. Neal Pressman

### DEATHS

Our congregational family extends its deepest sympathy to Jacob Romo and his family on the passing of his brother, Charles (Don) Romo, on September 10; and to the family and friends of Lucille Sherman on her passing on September 29.

May G-d comfort all of you in your moment of sorrow.